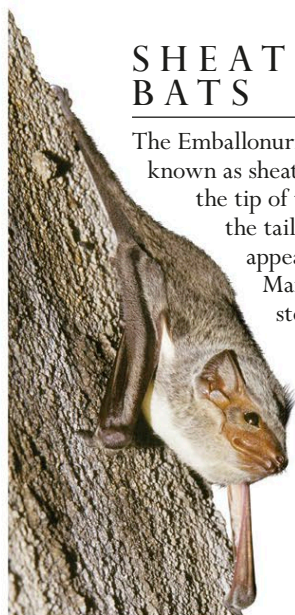


SHEATH-TAILED BATS

The Emballonuridae are more commonly known as sheath-tailed bats because just the tip of their tail protrudes through the tail membrane, giving it the appearance of being sheathed. Many have glandular odour-storing sacs on their wings.



7.5–8.5 cm
3–3½ in

HILDEGARDE'S TOMB BAT

Taphozous hildegardeae

Dependent on caves for roosting, Hildegard's tomb bat feeds on insects in the coastal forests of Kenya and Tanzania.

4–5 cm
1½–2 in

LESSER SHEATH-TAILED BAT

Emballonura monticola

The short tail of this bat appears to retract into a sheath when it stretches its legs. It lives in Indonesia, Malaysia, Myanmar, and Thailand.



3.5–5 cm
1½–2 in

PROBOSCIS BAT

Rhynchonycteris naso

These bats spend the day roosting in groups on the underside of branches. They live in tropical forest in C. and S. America.



4.5–6 cm
2–2½ in

GREATER SAC-WINGED BAT

Saccopteryx bilineata

Male greater sac-winged bats attract females by a pungent secretion in their wing sacs. The species is found in C. and S. America.

NEW WORLD LEAF-NOSED BATS

The Phyllostomidae contains species that are distributed from southwestern USA to northern Argentina. Most have large ears and a noseleaf, shaped like a spearhead, to enhance echolocation.

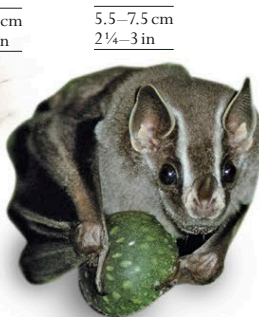


6.5–10 cm
2½–4 in

PALE SPEAR-NOSED BAT

Phyllostomus discolor

This species emits echolocation calls through its nose. It is found in C. and northern S. America.



5.5–7.5 cm
2¼–3 in

COMMON TENT-MAKING BAT

Uroderma bilobatum

Found in lowland forests from Mexico to central S. America, this bat creates shelters by biting palm and banana leaves.

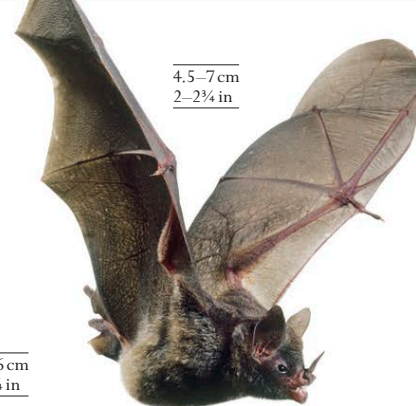


4.5–6 cm
2–2½ in

GERVAIS' FRUIT-EATING BAT

Artibeus cinereus

Preferring to roost in palm trees, Gervais' fruit-eating bat lives in S. America, including Venezuela, Brazil, and the Guianas.



4.5–7 cm
2–2½ in

SEBA'S SHORT-TAILED BAT

Carollia perspicillata

Inhabiting moist evergreen and dry deciduous forests across much of C. and S. America, this species is a generalist fruit eater.



4.5–6 cm
2–2½ in

SILKY SHORT-TAILED BAT

Carollia brevicaudum

This leaf-nosed bat is widespread in C. America and the Amazon region. It helps to restore degraded forests by dispersing the seeds of fruit trees.



7–9.5 cm
2¾–3¾ in

FRINGE-LIPPED BAT

Trachops cirrhosus

The fringe-lipped bat catches frogs by listening for their calls. It lives in tropical forest in C. and northern S. America.



6–8 cm
2¼–3¼ in

WHITE-LINED BROAD-NOSED BAT

Platyrrhinus lineatus

Named for the white lines on its face and back, this broad-nosed bat roosts in damp forests of central S. America.



8–10.5 cm
3¼–4¼ in

CALIFORNIAN LEAF-NOSED BAT

Macrotus californicus

Primarily hunting for moths by sight rather than echolocation, the Californian leaf-nosed bat lives in N. Mexico and the S.E. USA.



6–7.5 cm
2¼–3 in

GEOFFROY'S TAILLESS BAT

Anoura geoffroyi

A specialized nectar feeder, this species has a long muzzle, elongate cheek teeth, and a brush-tipped tongue. It lives in C. and S. America.



7–9.5 cm
2¾–3¾ in

COMMON VAMPIRE BAT

Desmodus rotundus

Famous for feeding on other mammals' blood, the common vampire bat occurs in a variety of habitats in Mexico and C. and S. America.